The 29th Degree – Scottish Knight of Saint Andrew



A Knight of St. Andrew wears a green collar edged with crimson, over the neck, and a white silk scarf, fringed with gold, and worn from left to right.

The jewel is a St. Andrew's Cross, of gold, with a large emerald in the center, surmounted by the helmet of a knight, and with a thistle of gold between the arms at the bottom. It is worn suspended from the collar. The emerald signifies the manliness and uprightness of chivalry, its color that of the renewal of virtue, always bright and sparkling. The thistle is the national emblem of Scotland and recalls a tradition that

> *...the Danes invaded Scotland and stealthily surrounded Staines Castle. They took off their shoes to wade the moat, only to find it dry and filled with thistles. The resultant yells and curses roused the garrison, and the Danes were soundly defeated.* (Leach, p. 1108).

The banner of the Order is a green St. Andrew's Cross on a white field fringed with gold. At the end of each arm of the cross is one of the four Hebrew letters that form the Ineffable Name of Deity. Above the cross is a circle of five stars with a thistle in the center.

DUTIES

Reverence and obey the Deity. Serve the truth.
Protect virtue and innocence. Defend the people against tyranny.

LESSONS

Ideas and institutions wax and wane in the great cycle of time which is but change.

FOR REFLECTION

Is virtue an armor stronger than the strongest metal?

IMPORTANT SYMBOLS:

St. Andrew's Cross, castle in ruins, armorless knight.

St. Andrew is said to have been crucified on an X–shaped cross, although there is no historical evidence to support this claim. Andrew is a Greek name and means "manly." St. Andrew was the brother of St. Peter and one of the first disciples chosen by Jesus. His character is one to be emulated; the Interpreter's Dictionary of the Bible describes St. Andrew:

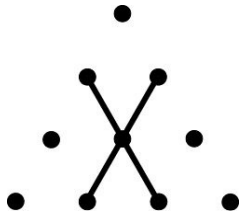
> *He was continually open to new light; he was pliable and teachable. When truth broke upon him, he accepted it enthusiastically and wished others to share it* (Vol. A–D, p. 126).

St. Andrew is the patron saint of Scotland; and the cross bearing his name appears on the Scottish flag. He is said to have appeared to Hungus, King of the Picts in the ninth century, promising him victory in a battle with the English King Athelstan who sought to conquer Scotland. In the sky that night St. Andrew placed the shape of the cross on which he was crucified as a token of

this promise or covenant. The Picts defeated Athelstan and thereby maintained their liberty, for a while.

The cross is not only a Christian symbol. Its history is long and widespread, encompassing a great many forms; the Encyclopedia Heraldica lists 385 different varieties. Plato tells us that the broken parts of the world soul were connected together with a stitch in the shape of an X (*Timaeus* 36). Since the St. Andrew's cross is perfectly symmetrical and crosses in general are symbolic of the conjunction of opposites, we may conclude that it also symbolizes the balance between the earthly and spiritual forces within man. Supporting this theme is the symbolic meaning of the number 10, which is represented as an X in the Roman numeral system; Pike notes,

> *The number 10, or the Denary, is the measure of everything; and reduces multiplied numbers to unity. ... among the Sages, [it was] a sign of concord, love and peace* (p. 638).



Ten is the number of dots in the Tetractys, that magical arrangement which contains within itself a host of geometrical figures. St. Andrew's cross also appears within the Tetractys as shown. Specifically, in regard to St. Andrew's cross, Pike says it was the Sign of the Creative Wisdom or Logos, the Son of God (p. 291). This designation comes, at least in part, from the use of the X to represent the Greek letter Chi, the first letter in Christos.

This degree is obviously chivalric, but not purely so. It is best viewed as transitional, for in its symbolism it links the 27th Degree, Knight of the Sun, a purely Philosophical Degree, with the 30th, Knight Kadosh, a clearly chivalric degree. Several examples of symbolic transition may be readily found.



In the 30th Degree, we encounter the skulls with a miter and a crown and we learn of De Molay burning at the stake, a martyr of the Knights Templar. In this degree also, in transparencies, we see these images briefly. The St. Andrew's Cross, an X, is formed from two V shapes, one inverted, touching at their apexes. Masonic scholars have long sought to learn the origin and development of Masonry; many have seen in the Knights Templar, numerous parallels to suggest this Order practiced the Masonry of the Middle Ages. The Knights Templar were ordered to disband and relinquish all their possessions by Pope Clement V in 1307. Many were imprisoned in France and executed or tortured at the order of Philip the Fair. These impoverished and persecuted Knights sought refuge in other countries, joining acceptable orders or changing their name. In the Legenda we read the story that in Scotland they found protection and joined the army of King Robert Bruce. Since the Templars' assistance was vital to the victory of Bruce over Edward II of England, this legend tells us Bruce created the Order of Saint Andrew of Scotland, thereby subsuming the Templars into the Scottish system of knighthood.

CEREMONY

The degree opens in the Hall of the Chapter. Its hangings are crimson supported by white columns, the colors of the Knights Templar. St. Andrew's cross appears in a transparency over the Master and may be drawn by connecting the four lights in the Northeast, Northwest, Southwest and Southeast corners of the altar. In front of each of the three principal officers is an equilateral triangle formed by three lights. In the opening, the lights on the altar are lit one by one, each accompanied by the pronunciation of the four letters which comprise the

Tetragrammaton or name of Deity ascribed by the Hebrews: Yod, He, Vau and He. The four lights are also representative of the duties of a Knight of St. Andrew: one, to reverence and obey the Deity; two, to serve the Truth; three, to protect virtue and innocence; and four, to battle manfully for truth and right, free speech and free thought, defending the people against tyranny. We also see these letters upon the cross on the banner of the Order in the illustration at the beginning of this degree summary.

The candidate is received in a second apartment, which represents the roofless court of an old ruined castle in which the Knights are encamped. The castle in ruins represents the destruction of knighthood and the age of chivalry, of the waxing and waning of institutions and of the rise, destruction and re–birth of the knightly orders.

To be accepted within these ruins, the candidate must submit to all the rules and laws of the Order, to enter into probation for a term of one year and to become a brother to aid in re–establishing the Order of the Temple.

The first lesson concerns the three excellent virtues of humility, patience and self–denial. To dramatically teach these lessons, the candidate is charged with ensuring the safety of the banner of the Order. To do this duty, and fight, if necessary, in defense of the banner, the candidate is dressed in a cassock of white linen and given a sword and a shield. He must defend the banner without the protection afforded by defensive armor. But if he be truly a Prince and Knight of Masonry, virtue is an armor stronger than the strongest metal and will afford him protection.

> *[Virtue] is an armor that we cannot lose, unless we be false to ourselves”* (p. 803).

The candidate is obligated by the Prior or Senior Warden; in fact, he has not yet seen the Master who is concealed behind curtains. The unseen Master is symbolic at several different levels– the death by burning alive of the Templar leader in 1314 which left the Order without a Master, the Deity who is “Master”

of all, and particularly of virtue, truth and honor which are not visible qualities but qualities which demonstrate themselves by practice.

The final oratory, in addition to the associated legend, is a series of inspiring quotes from historic figures and some of the most eloquent and poetic analogies between nature, virtue and honor in any of the degrees of the Rite.

When Pine Bayard [(1472–1524) a French soldier and paragon of knightly virtue] was asked what inheritance a father was bound to leave his children, he replied, “He should leave them, the mind that fears neither rain nor tempest, nor force of man, nor human injustice; and that is wisdom and virtue.”

We ought to love life; we ought to desire to live here so long as God ordains it; but let us not so encase ourselves in time that we cannot break the crust and begin to throw out shoots for the other life.

The history of human thought is the only history that deserves much study. Thus men are kept alive on earth by that which is invisible, and sunk to the bottom by that which is material. Time is made up of waters so thin, that nothing may float thereon which is heavier than unseen truths, and treasures of the intellect and heart.

To think of death is not to make us discontented with life, but to bring us back with more strength and a nobler purpose in living. A banner long unused, and laid away in a dark chamber, grows dusty and moth–eaten, and needs for its preservation to be unrolled and shaken out, and borne high in the air; so our spiritual life decays in the confinement and darkness of the world; and that it may gain new vigor, our thoughts must now and then be unfurled, and held high, and shaken in the air of heaven.

We see again the great cycle of time represented by the thoughts of these great men, revitalized in Masonry and brought again to importance. The cycle of nature, of which death is only a part, teaches us that truth will again blossom in the world and that death is not to be feared.

LECTURE

The lecture includes a section by another author, Bro. Rev. W.W. Lord, 32°. Brother Lord's contribution discusses religion, science, great calamities and Masonry in the 19th century, which he calls the Age of Iron and characterizes as a troubled time. His discussion of events current at the original publication of Morals and Dogma is intermingled with instruction on Masonic attitudes and philosophy. From this addition, we clearly see the timeless quality of Masonic instruction. He concludes with the thought that we are responsible for ourselves:

Men are great or small in stature as it pleases God. But their nature is great or small as it pleases themselves. Men are not born, some with great souls and some with little souls. ...By an act of the will he can make himself a moral giant, or dwarf himself to a pigmy.

There are two natures in man, the higher and the lower, the great and the mean, the noble and the ignoble; and he can and must, by his own voluntary act, identify himself with the one or with the other. Freemasonry is continual effort to exalt the nobler nature over the ignoble, the spiritual over the material, the divine in man over the human (p. 813).

In his contribution to this lecture, Pike discusses the practice of the nine knightly qualities presented in the ritual and encourages reflection on the past and the future.

Humility, Patience and Self–Denial:

Humility, Patience, and Self–denial are the three essential qualities of a Knight of St. Andrew of Scotland. The Cross ... is an unmistakable and eloquent symbol of these three virtues. ... [Jesus'] *life was one of Humility, Patience, and Self–denial* (pp. 801–802).

Charity, Generosity and Clemency:

The Knights of St. Andrew vowed to defend all orphans, maidens, and widows of good family, and wherever they heard of murderers, robbers, or masterful thieves

who oppressed the people, to bring them to the laws, to the best of their power (p. 802).

"If fortune fall you," so ran the vows of Rouge–Croix, "in diverse lands or countries ... that you find any gentleman of name and arms, which hath lost goods, in worship and Knighthood ...and is fallen into poverty, you shall aid, and support, and succor him, in that you may; and he ask of you your goods to his sustenance, you shall give him part of such goods as God hath sent you to your power, and as you may bear" (pp. 802–803).

[Clemency] is a mark of a noble nature to spare the conquered. Valor is then best tempered, when it can turn out a stern fortitude into the mild strains of pity, which never shines more brightly than when she is clad in steel. ... The most famed men in the world have had in them both courage and compassion. An enemy reconciled hath a greater value than the long train of captives of a Roman triumph (p. 803).

Virtue, Truth and Honor:

The law hath not power to strike the virtuous, nor can fortune subvert the wise. Virtue and Wisdom, only, perfect and defend man. ... [Virtue] protects us when we are unarmed; and is an armor that we cannot lose, unless we be false to ourselves. It is the tenure by which we hold of Heaven, without which we are but outlaws, that cannot claim protection. Nor is there wisdom without virtue, but only a cunning way of procuring our own undoing (p. 803).

If you ... would be respectable as a Knight, and not a mere tinselled pretender and Knight of straw, you must practise, and be diligent and ardent in the practice of, the virtues you have professed in this Degree. ... How vow to be zealous and constant in the service of the Order and be as useless to it as if he were dead and buried? What does the symbolism of the Compass and Square profit him, if his sensual appetites and baser passions are not governed by, but domineer over his moral sense and reason, the animal over the divine, the earthly over the spiritual, both points of the compass remaining below the

Square? What a hideous mockery to call one Brother, whom he maligns to the Profane, lends money unto at usury, defrauds in trade, or plunders at law by chicanery? (pp. 807–808).

Look to the Past and the Future:

It has been well said, that whatever withdraws us from the power of our senses, whatever makes the Past, the Distant, or the Future, predominate over the Present, advances us in the dignity of thinking beings (p. 806).

Look to the ancient days ... for excellent examples of Virtue, Truth and honor, and imitate with noble emulation the Ancient Knights...; in the words of Pliny ..., revere the ancient glory, and that old age which in man is venerable, in cities sacred. Honor antiquity and great deeds, and detract nothing from the dignity and liberty of any one (p. 804).

But neither must you believe that, even in this very different age, ... there are no men of the antique stamp for you to revere, no heroic and knightly souls, that preserve their nobleness and equanimity in the chaos of conflicting passions, of ambition and baseness that welters around them (p. 805).

To Be a Knight of St. Andrew:

... lay aside all uncharitable and repining feeling; be proof henceforward against the suggestions of undisciplined passion and inhuman zeal; learn to hate the vices and not the vicious; be content with the discharge of the duties which your Masonic and Knightly professions require; be governed by the old principles of honor and chivalry, and reverence with constancy that Truth which is as sacred and immutable as God Himself. And above all, remember always, that jealousy is not our life, nor disputation our end, nor disunion our health, nor revenge our happiness; but loving–kindness is all these, greater than Hope, greater than Faith, which can remove mountains, properly the only thing which God requires of us, and in the possession of which lies the fulfillment of all our duties (p. 808).



Knight, Death and the Devil
by Albrecht Durer